

1801

FIRST BARBARY WAR BEGINS

States trading across the Mediterranean were forced to pay tribute to North Africa's Barbary states to gain protection from pirates. American refusal to pay triggered conflict between the US and Tripoli, which ended only after US forces captured Derna in Tripoli in 1805.

▽ US Marines board a Tripolitan gunboat



1802

NGUYEN ANH UNITES VIETNAM AND BECOMES EMPEROR

After capturing Saigon in 1788, Nguyen Anh struck at the Tay So'n rulers of Vietnam from his base in the south. He slowly united the country after centuries of internal conflict and ruled as Emperor Gia Long until his death in 1820. His dynasty was Vietnam's last; by 1883 Vietnam was part of French Indo-China.



◀ Emperor Gia Long
(1762-1820)

1800

1800 Napoleon crosses the Alps to beat the Austrians at the Battle of Marengo

1801 The Act of Union unites Great Britain and Ireland as the United Kingdom

“The word impossible is not French.”

NAPOLEON BONAPARTE, 1813

1800-1991

BATTERY TECHNOLOGY

The invention of batteries, which convert chemical energy into electric energy, unlocked the possibilities of portable power.



1800 Alessandro Volta, an Italian physicist, develops a pile that produces a steady electrical current.



1859 The lead-acid battery is invented by French physicist Gaston Planté. It is a reversible, rechargeable, electrochemical cell that soon finds many uses.



1886 Georges Leclanché develops longer-lasting dry-cell batteries using zinc-carbon electrodes and ammonium chloride paste.



1991 Lithium-ion batteries are produced commercially. Rechargeable, light, and powerful, they are used in portable electronic devices.